Six small stories to solve

Tiny Guests

Name _____ Date _____

Show your thinking with a drawing, numbers, or words.

1. Little draws 28 soap bubbles, then draws 17 more. How many bubbles are on the page?

28 + 17 = _____

Show your thinking.

2. Little plans to scrub for 20 seconds. So far, 8 seconds have passed. How many seconds of scrubbing remain?

20 − 8 = _____

Show your thinking.

3. A breakfast shelf has 24 yogurt cups. Big adds 18 cups. How many yogurt cups are on the shelf now?

24 + 18 = _____

Show your thinking.

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4. Little draws 52 helpful bacteria in a notebook and colors 16 of them. How many drawings still need color?

52 − 16 = _____

Show your thinking.

5. One book page shows 35 helpful bacteria. Another page shows 27. How many bacteria are shown on the two pages?

35 + 27 = _____

Show your thinking.

6. Little has 63 bubble stickers and uses 25 on a handwashing poster. How many stickers are left?

63 − 25 = _____

Show your thinking.

WONDER DAILY

Tiny Guests

A little book of tiny guests



Two tiny guests. One kind habit.

GRADE 3

Make a little book.

1. Print one-sided: US Letter, portrait, actual size / 100%. No fit. Headers/footers off.
2. Fold long edge to long edge; reopen. Fold short edge to short edge, then in half again. Open: eight boxes.
3. Cut only the solid center line across the middle two boxes. Keep the outer boxes joined.
4. Refold long edge to long edge, print outside. Push ends together to open a diamond, then a cross.
5. Wrap into a book with page 1 in front. Follow pages 1 to 8.



Look closely, wonder, and pause whenever you like.

Your turn

Write one command sentence for washing hands.

Example: First wet your hands, then scrub with soap for 20 seconds.



"Your immune system is your body's team of defenders," said Big. "Some learn to recognize germs and remember them next time." Little saved a shape in the notebook, then a command: "Rinse your hands well." What other kind habits could Little keep?



"Does one medicine work on both guests?" Little asked. Big shook their head. "An antibiotic is a medicine that works on bacteria. It does not work on viruses, because they do not have the same cell parts." Little compared the two shapes again. Different tiny guests needed different kinds of help.



Back at the sink, Little made a soft lather. Soap can pull apart the oily outer layers of many germs. It also loosens germs from skin. "Wet. Add soap. Scrub for 20 seconds. Rinse. Dry." Little said. Water carried the loosened guests away. A small habit could do a lot.



The next guest was much smaller. A virus is a tiny package of instructions in a coat, not a cell. It cannot make copies alone. It must borrow a living cell's machinery: the parts that do the work. "Like a program saying 'copy me'?" asked Little. "Instructions that need a cell," said Big.



Little paused at a yogurt cup. "Are all bacteria a problem?" "Many are helpers," said Big. "Some live happily in your gut and help with food. Others help make yogurt. Some can make people unwell." A bacterium is one whole living cell: a tiny unit with the parts it needs to live.



Little Wonderer held a magnifier beside the sink. "Can I see the tiny guests on my hands?" "Germs are far too small for just our eyes," said Big. "Even that magnifier cannot show them." They opened a book. Bacteria and viruses waited on its pages. Were these tiny guests alike?

Give a kind habit its words

Tiny Guests · Curiosity day

Name _____ Date _____

Write one clear command sentence about washing hands. You can say it first.



Guests beyond our eyes



A kind habit



A clue to remember

Draw one handwashing step. Add one label.

wet · soap · scrub · rinse · dry · hands · first · then

First, ... tell how to begin

Then, ... tell how to use soap and scrub

At the end, ... tell how to rinse or dry

Read your sentence. Does it tell what to do, with a command such as Wet, Scrub, Rinse, or Dry?